



COMMUNITY GUIDES

Communication Access Scorecard

A ten-question self-assessment for schools, clinics, libraries, and nonprofits.

How easy is your organization's communication to understand — and how accessible is it to the multilingual families you serve? Work through the ten questions, tally your score, and use the guide to decide what to improve first.

Using this scorecard

For each question, check **Yes**, **Partly**, or **No**, and jot a note. Count one point for every “Yes.” Then read the scoring guide. This is a self-assessment to spark improvement — not a formal compliance audit.

QUESTION	Y · PARTLY · N	NOTES
1. Are your public materials written at an accessible reading level (roughly 6th–8th grade)? Most adults, in any language, understand plain language best.	☐ ☐ ☐	
2. Are your most important documents available in the languages your community speaks? Even translating your top three documents removes a major barrier.	☐ ☐ ☐	
3. Does a second bilingual reader review translations before you publish them? A quick second review catches errors machine translation misses.	☐ ☐ ☐	
4. Do your materials avoid jargon and acronyms, or explain them when unavoidable? Terms like “EOB” or “RSVP” are invisible walls for many readers.	☐ ☐ ☐	
5. Does every notice state a clear next step — who to contact, where, by when? Understanding a message only helps if people know what to do next.	☐ ☐ ☐	
6. Do you use visuals — icons, photos, maps — to support key information? Visual support helps readers at every literacy level and language.	☐ ☐ ☐	
7. Can families reach a real person who can help in their language? An English-only phone tree can undo everything your materials get right.	☐ ☐ ☐	
8. Is your signage understandable to someone who reads limited English? Arrows, symbols, and translated headers make spaces navigable.	☐ ☐ ☐	
9. Do you tell your community, in their language, that language help exists? People can’t request an interpreter they don’t know is available.	☐ ☐ ☐	
10. Have you asked multilingual families for feedback in the past year? The people using your materials are the best judges of whether they work.	☐ ☐ ☐	

YOUR RESULT

Scoring guide

SCORE	WHAT IT SUGGESTS
9–10 · Strong	Strong access habits. Keep gathering community feedback — needs change as communities do.
6–8 · Good start	Several things are working, but a few gaps are likely blocking families. Start with the unchecked items on your most-used documents.
0–5 · Big opportunity	Real room to grow — and the good news is that small changes (plain-language rewrites, translating your top documents) have outsized impact.

NEXT STEPS

Turning a score into a plan

- 1 Pick your three most-used documents.** The intake form, the welcome flyer, the appointment reminder — start where volume is highest.
- 2 Fix reading level first.** Shorter sentences, everyday words, one clear next step. It’s the fastest, cheapest win.
- 3 Translate what matters most,** and have a second bilingual reader check it.
- 4 Ask five families** whether they understood — then believe what they tell you.

MSC CAN HELP

Our volunteers assist community organizations with plain-language rewrites, translation review, and communication-access checks — at no cost. Reach us at hello@makespanishcasual.org.

An educational self-assessment from the Multilingual Support Collective. Not a legal or compliance audit.